

Platner’s ‘simple job’ tells a story

Harbormaster role praised and dismissed

By Sam Brodey
GLOBE STAFF

Two years before he ran for Senate, Graham Platner raised his hand to take on a different role in government.

The job didn’t come with even modest authority or policy making heft. The pace of work was sporadic, the pay so minimal as to be a formality. For the most part, duties entailed diving into paperwork, or, occasionally, the brisk waters of Frenchman Bay.

But for Platner, that position — harbormaster of Sullivan, Maine — was a satisfying one. From January 2024 until a month after he launched his campaign, it was Platner’s responsibility to maintain the harbor in his small hometown, population roughly 1,200.

In an interview with the Globe, Platner called harbormaster “a very, very part-time job” but “one that I enjoyed immensely.” He called it a way for him to lend his experience and skills to benefit Sullivan, a place where he said “people pitch in where they can.”

HARBORMASTER, Page A9

From 1976, the way the Globe thought we’d be

By Billy Baker
GLOBE STAFF

Fifty years ago, the day after America’s bicentennial, the Boston Sunday Globe tried a little something. Wrapped around the paper was a satirical front page, dated 100 years in the future, July 5, 2076, pretending to cover our 300th anniversary.

“Tu our reders” it read. “In honor of the Tricentennial, we ar sending u an aniversary copi of The Boston Sunday Globe printed on the paper used in yers past, insted of thru yor hom computer readout.”

Well, they kinda nailed the coming disemvoweling we call text-speak, and the “hom computer readout,” even if its hom is now in our pockets. But thankfully, as a “special treat,” the rest of the wrap is “riten in the old english and spelling in use befor the Language Reform Act of 2013.”

Interestingly, we tried the same gag in 1881, when the 9-1976, Page A8

Spotlight

Ties to developers questioned



FINN GOMEZ FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

Taylor Dickerson and her husband say MassHousing officials promised them support but didn’t deliver.

Review points to fraud at certain MassHousing projects

By Joey Flechas and Gordon Russell
GLOBE STAFF

PITTSFIELD — When the state’s affordable housing finance agency launched a multimillion-dollar grant program to fix up blighted properties in struggling mill towns three years ago, the biggest chunk of the money went to a pair of young developers with a modest track record and powerful friends.

The \$1.4 million investment didn’t pan out the way officials at MassHousing hoped.

Instead of getting full makeovers, the four buildings in Worcester and Pittsfield still had myriad problems: rickety stairways, deficient siding, peeling paint, nasty refrigerators and toilets, and a possible bedbug infestation, according to post-renovation inspections. Some low-quality kitchen countertops had been inexplicably painted over.

The lone tenant in the Worcester triple-decker targeted for renovation, 76-year-old Stephen Jenkins, called the modest improvements to his unit

“some half-ass [expletive],” saying the developers relied on “sidewalk Wil- lies,” or uncredentialed handymen.

Fraud is also at least partly to blame for the disappointing outcome, the Globe Spotlight Team found. At least nine subcontractors flatly denied doing the work attributed to them, for which the state paid nearly \$580,000. Another two said they suspected the invoices the developers attributed to them were inaccurate. Only two subcontractors reached by the Globe con-

SPOTLIGHT, Page A12

AVENUE OF BROKEN TRUST

Many Black residents in Mattapan greet plan for redesign of Blue Hill Avenue with skepticism



Top: A view of Blue Hill Avenue and River Street near Mattapan Square. Right: Mac Hudson, who lives on Blue Hill Avenue, spoke at a March community meeting on the center bus lane proposal.



TOP: DANIELLE PARHIZKARAN/GLOBE STAFF; ABOVE: ANDREW BURKE-STEVENSON/FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

By Emma Platoff
GLOBE STAFF

In the middle of Blue Hill Avenue’s weeknight chaos — the triple-parked cars and the scooters zipping around them; the parents gripping their children’s hands as they step off the sidewalk to cross; the city bus lumbering along, belching and hissing — one segment of the street is stagnant: the wide, empty median.

On a street where everyone is battling for space, and every inch is contested, this barren strip sits right in the center of everything, in most places entirely useless. The cracked concrete is a reminder of the inaction and disinvestment that’s made this crucial artery through Black Boston so frustrating and dangerous to navigate.

“Cambridge has beautiful streets and bike lanes, beautiful bus stops, all that,” said Glorian Lee, 18, who lives near Franklin Park and takes the 28 bus down Blue Hill Avenue every day. “Why can we not have the same thing?”

BLUE HILL AVENUE, Page A14

The Cape Ann Museum reopens this week after 20 months, with a major exhibition. **SundayArts, N1.**

Eleven people were hurt, one seriously, when a duck boat tipped over in Cambridge after a tow rope attached to it broke. **Metro, B4.**

Glasgow is Boston’s newest sister city, and the best one, writes Christopher Muther. **SundayTravel, N11.**

Lowell is thrilled with the return of baseball and the Spinners at LeLacheur Park. **Sports, C1.**

An outside chance

Sunday: Partly sunny. High: 70-75. Low: 62-67.

Monday: Sunny. High: 75-80. Low: 64-69.

Sunrise: 5:10 Sunset: 8:25

Complete report, **A24**. Deaths, **A18-23**.



VOL. 309, NO. 179

Suggested retail price \$6.00



Boost your savings with confidence.

GET A VARIABLE RATE UP TO

4.00% APY

for 6 months* on balances of \$25,000–\$10,000,000 with an Eastern Bank Money Market Plus

Earn up to 4.00% Annual Percentage Yield* with a 6-month interest rate boost. 180 days after account opening, the APY will revert to the standard, variable APY of up to 3.25%. Rates are subject to account balances.

Apply now at **EasternBank.com/MoneyMarket** or visit your local branch.

Eastern Bank
JOIN US FOR GOOD®

Balances	Standard APY*	Boosted APY*	Blended APY*
\$10–\$24,999	0.01%	0.74%	0.37%
\$25,000–\$10,000,000	3.25%	4.00%	3.62%
\$10,000,000.01+	0.01%	0.74%	0.37%

*Annual Percentage Yield (APY) is accurate as of 6/26/2026. This offer, interest rates, or APY are subject to change at any time without notice at the discretion of the Bank. Fees may reduce earnings. Minimum Deposit Requirement for opening account: \$25,000 and must be new money not already on deposit with Eastern Bank. Offer limited to one account per taxpayer identification number. Please refer to the Personal Deposit Account Agreement for details.

Member FDIC.